

BONUS 8 OF 12

Crochet Companion

Expand your craft — crochet patterns and techniques for knitters
crossing over

Contents

Knitting vs Crochet — Side-by-Side	1
Essential Crochet Stitches	2
Reading Crochet Patterns	3
Your First Crochet Projects	4
Intermediate Crochet Patterns	5
Converting Knitting Skills to Crochet	6
Troubleshooting Crochet	7

SECTION 1

Knitting vs Crochet — Side-by-Side

Understanding the key differences so you can leverage what you already know

As an experienced knitter, you already understand yarn weights, tension, and gauge. Crochet shares many of these fundamentals but differs in tools, technique, and the fabric it produces. This comparison will help you map your existing knowledge to the new craft.

FEATURE	KNITTING	CROCHET
Primary tool	Two needles (or circular/DPNs)	One hook
Active loops	Many stitches live on the needle	One active loop at a time
Basic stitch unit	Knit and purl	Chain and single crochet
Fabric character	Thinner, more drape	Thicker, sturdier, more textured
Yarn usage	Uses less yarn per area	Uses roughly 30% more yarn
Ease of fixing mistakes	Dropped stitches can ladder down	Simply pull back to the error
Shaping	Increases and decreases on row	Increases, decreases, and turning chains
Working in the round	DPNs or circular needles	Single hook with stitch marker
Stitch height	Shorter stitches per row	Varies widely (sc short, dc tall)
Best for	Garments, socks, fine lace	Amigurumi, blankets, edgings, 3D shapes

Knitter's advantage

You already understand gauge swatches, yarn labels, and blocking. These skills transfer directly — you are not starting from zero.

SECTION 2

Essential Crochet Stitches

The five foundation stitches every beginner needs, with row-by-row instructions

Chain Stitch (ch)

The chain is the crochet equivalent of casting on. Almost every project begins with a foundation chain.

- 1 Make a slip knot and place it on your hook.
- 2 Yarn over (wrap yarn over hook from back to front).
- 3 Pull the yarn through the loop on the hook. One chain made.
- 4 Repeat steps 2–3 for each chain needed. Keep chains loose and even.

Single Crochet (sc)

The shortest and densest basic stitch. Creates a tight, firm fabric ideal for amigurumi and potholders.

- 1 Insert hook into the next stitch (or second chain from hook on a foundation row).
- 2 Yarn over and pull through the stitch. You now have two loops on hook.
- 3 Yarn over and pull through both loops on hook. One single crochet made.
- 4 At the end of the row, chain 1 (turning chain), turn work. The ch-1 does not count as a stitch.

Half Double Crochet (hdc)

Slightly taller than single crochet with a bit more drape. Good for hats and scarves.

- 1 Yarn over, then insert hook into the next stitch.
- 2 Yarn over and pull through the stitch. You now have three loops on hook.
- 3 Yarn over and pull through all three loops at once. One hdc made.
- 4 At the end of the row, chain 2, turn. The ch-2 counts as the first hdc of the next row.

Double Crochet (dc)

The workhorse stitch of crochet — tall, versatile, and quick to work. Most blanket and garment patterns use it.

- 1 Yarn over, insert hook into the next stitch.
- 2 Yarn over and pull through the stitch. Three loops on hook.
- 3 Yarn over and pull through the first two loops. Two loops remain.
- 4 Yarn over and pull through the last two loops. One dc made.
- 5 At the end of the row, chain 3, turn. The ch-3 counts as the first dc of the next row.

Treble Crochet (tr)

The tallest common stitch, creating an open, lacy fabric. Used for shawls and decorative patterns.

- 1 Yarn over twice, insert hook into the next stitch.
- 2 Yarn over and pull through the stitch. Four loops on hook.
- 3 Yarn over and pull through the first two loops. Three loops remain.
- 4 Yarn over and pull through the next two loops. Two loops remain.
- 5 Yarn over and pull through the last two loops. One tr made.
- 6 At the end of the row, chain 4, turn. The ch-4 counts as the first tr of the next row.

SECTION 3

Reading Crochet Patterns

Decode abbreviations, symbols, and pattern structure with confidence

Crochet patterns use a standard set of abbreviations. If you can read a knitting pattern, you will adapt quickly — the format is very similar.

Common Abbreviations

ABBREVIATION	MEANING	NOTES
ch	Chain	Foundation or turning chain
sl st	Slip stitch	Used to join rounds or move yarn
sc	Single crochet	UK term: double crochet (dc)
hdc	Half double crochet	UK term: half treble (htr)
dc	Double crochet	UK term: treble (tr)
tr	Treble crochet	UK term: double treble (dtr)
sk	Skip	Skip the next stitch
inc	Increase	Two stitches in the same stitch
dec / sc2tog	Decrease	Two stitches worked together
yo	Yarn over	Wrap yarn over hook
BLO / FLO	Back / front loop only	Creates a ribbed texture
RS / WS	Right side / wrong side	Same as knitting
rep	Repeat	Often shown with brackets or asterisks

US vs UK terminology

US and UK crochet terms use the same words for different stitches. A UK "double crochet" is a US "single crochet." Always check whether a pattern uses US or UK terms before starting. This guide uses US terms throughout.

Pattern Structure

A typical crochet pattern includes these sections, in order:

- **Skill level** — beginner, intermediate, or advanced.
- **Finished measurements** — dimensions of the completed piece.
- **Materials** — yarn weight, yardage, hook size, and notions.
- **Gauge** — number of stitches and rows per 10 cm / 4 in.
- **Special stitches** — any non-standard stitches defined before instructions.
- **Instructions** — row-by-row or round-by-round directions.
- **Finishing** — seaming, blocking, and assembly.

Reading Symbols in Charts

Crochet charts are visual diagrams where each symbol represents a stitch. Unlike knitting charts (read right-to-left on RS rows), crochet charts show the work as it appears from the right side.

SYMBOL	STITCH
Small oval or dot	Chain (ch)
Plus sign or X	Single crochet (sc)
T shape	Half double crochet (hdc)
T with one crossbar	Double crochet (dc)
T with two crossbars	Treble crochet (tr)
Filled dot	Slip stitch (sl st)

SECTION 4

Your First Crochet Projects

15 beginner-friendly patterns to build your confidence with hook and yarn

These patterns use only chain, single crochet, and double crochet. Each is designed to be completed in a few hours.

Classic Dishcloth

Beginner 100% cotton worsted, 5.0 mm hook

A simple square worked in single crochet rows. The dense fabric is perfect for kitchen use, and the repetitive stitching builds muscle memory fast.

Ribbed Scarf

Beginner Worsted weight acrylic, 5.5 mm hook

Worked sideways in back-loop-only single crochet to create a stretchy rib that mimics knitted ribbing. A great first wearable project.

Granny Square Coaster Set

Beginner Cotton DK weight, 4.0 mm hook

The iconic granny square in miniature. Learn to work in the round, change colors, and join rounds with a slip stitch.

Simple Headband

Beginner Worsted weight wool blend, 5.0 mm

hook

A narrow rectangle of half double crochet, seamed into a loop. Quick to make and a practical way to practice even tension.

Chunky Mug Cozy

Beginner Worsted weight acrylic, 5.0 mm hook,

one button

A short rectangle of single crochet fastened with a button loop. Introduces basic shaping and finishing in a tiny project.

Striped Potholder

Beginner Cotton worsted in two colors, 5.0 mm

hook

Worked in single crochet with color changes every two rows. Teaches clean color transitions and weaving in ends.

Baby Washcloth Trio

Beginner Soft cotton DK, 4.0 mm hook

Three small cloths, each in a different basic stitch (sc, hdc, dc). Compare the textures and see how stitch height affects fabric.

Phone Sleeve

Beginner DK cotton or acrylic, 4.0 mm hook

A flat rectangle folded and seamed on two sides. Practice consistent gauge on a small project with an immediately useful result.

Market Bag

Beginner Cotton worsted, 5.5 mm hook

Worked in the round from the bottom up using double crochet with chain spaces for stretch. Learn increases in the round and simple handle construction.

Textured Cowl

Beginner Bulky weight wool blend, 6.5 mm hook

A wide rectangle of alternating sc and dc rows, joined into a loop. The stitch contrast creates visual texture with zero complexity.

Plant Hanger

Beginner Cotton worsted or jute twine, 5.0 mm

hook

A small basket worked in continuous rounds of single crochet, with chain-space arms. Introduces working in a spiral without joining.

Bookmark Strip

Beginner Crochet thread size 10, 1.75 mm steel

hook

A narrow strip of double crochet with a picot edge. A quick introduction to finer thread work and decorative edging.

Color-Block Blanket Square

Beginner Worsted weight in three colors, 5.0 mm

hook

A large granny square worked in three-color blocks. Build several and seam them for a full blanket when your skills grow.

Simple Beanie

Beginner Worsted weight acrylic, 5.0 mm hook,

stitch marker

Worked from the crown down in continuous rounds of double crochet. Learn magic ring, even increases, and measuring for fit.

Boot Cuffs

Beginner

Worsted weight wool blend, 5.0 mm

hook

A short tube of front-post and back-post double crochet that mimics knitted ribbing. An excellent first texture-stitch project.

SECTION 5

Intermediate Crochet Patterns

15 patterns that introduce new techniques, shaping, and stitch combinations

Ready to level up? These patterns add colorwork, post stitches, garment shaping, and more complex construction.

Ripple Blanket

Intermediate

Worsted weight in 5 colors, 5.5 mm

hook

The classic chevron pattern using increases and decreases at regular intervals. A meditative project that teaches rhythm in stitch counting.

Granny Square Cardigan

Intermediate

DK weight wool blend, 4.5 mm

hook

Assemble hexagonal and square granny motifs into a wearable jacket. Learn motif joining, armhole shaping, and edging.

Filet Crochet Table Runner

Intermediate

Crochet thread size 10, 1.75 mm

steel hook

A grid of open and filled squares forms a floral pattern. Introduces chart reading and the filet crochet technique.

Amigurumi Bear

Intermediate

DK weight cotton, 3.5 mm hook,

safety eyes, stuffing

A stuffed toy worked in continuous single crochet rounds. Learn invisible decreases, shaping curves, and assembling limbs.

Cable-Stitch Ear Warmer

Intermediate

Worsted weight wool, 5.0 mm hook

Front-post and back-post double crochets create cable twists that rival knitted cables. A compact project to master post stitches.

Tapestry Crochet Pouch

Intermediate

DK cotton in two colors, 3.5 mm

hook

Carry the unused color inside the stitches for colorwork motifs. Learn tapestry crochet tension and reading color charts.

Lacy Summer Top

Intermediate

DK weight cotton or linen, 4.0 mm

hook

A sleeveless shell worked top-down with a lace yoke. Introduces garment construction, bust shaping, and lace repeats.

Mosaic Crochet Scarf

Intermediate

DK weight in two contrasting

colors, 4.5 mm hook

Overlay colorwork using dropped stitches into rows below. Creates geometric patterns while working only one color per row.

Crochet Socks

Intermediate

Fingering weight sock yarn, 2.75

mm hook

Toe-up construction with short-row heel shaping. Your knitting sock knowledge maps directly to understanding fit and ease.

Basket Weave Baby Blanket

Intermediate

DK weight acrylic, 4.5 mm hook

Alternating blocks of front-post and back-post dc create a woven texture. Practice counting and maintaining stitch pattern across a wide piece.

Mandala Wall Hanging

Intermediate

DK cotton in 4 colors, 4.0 mm

hook, wooden ring

A flat circular motif using puff stitches, chains, and color changes. Introduces decorative stitches and working large flat circles.

Herringbone Throw Pillow

Intermediate

Chunky weight yarn, 6.5 mm hook,

pillow insert

The herringbone half double crochet creates a knit-look diagonal texture. Two panels are seamed around an insert for a polished finish.

C2C (Corner to Corner) Blanket

Intermediate

Worsted weight in 3 colors, 5.0 mm

hook

Worked diagonally from one corner using small dc clusters. Learn the increase and decrease phases and how to read pixel-art charts.

Tunisian Crochet Sampler

Intermediate

Worsted weight, Tunisian crochet

hook (5.0 mm with cable)

A sampler strip of five Tunisian stitches (simple, knit, purl, honeycomb, smock).

Bridges the gap between knitting and crochet with a forward-and-return pass technique.

Slouchy Beret

Intermediate

DK weight wool, 4.5 mm hook

Shaped with increases in the crown and decreases toward the brim. Combines post stitches and puff stitches for a textured look.

SECTION 6

Converting Knitting Skills to Crochet

Map what you already know to the new craft and avoid common crossover traps

Skills that transfer directly

Reading yarn labels, choosing fiber for a project, gauge swatching, wet blocking, mattress stitch seaming, and understanding ease — all of these work exactly the same in crochet.

Yarn Weight and Hook Size Equivalency

YARN WEIGHT	KNITTING NEEDLE (MM)	CROCHET HOOK (MM)	COMMON USES
Lace / Fingering	2.0 – 3.25	1.75 – 3.0	Doilies, fine shawls, socks
Sport	3.25 – 3.75	3.0 – 3.5	Baby garments, light scarves
DK	3.75 – 4.5	3.5 – 4.5	Garments, amigurumi, blankets
Worsted / Aran	4.5 – 5.5	5.0 – 6.0	Blankets, hats, bags
Bulky	5.5 – 8.0	6.0 – 9.0	Quick blankets, cowls, rugs
Super Bulky	8.0 – 12.0	9.0 – 16.0	Arm-style projects, chunky throws

Why crochet hooks are often larger

Crochet stitches are taller and yarn wraps around the hook more. Using a slightly larger hook than the equivalent knitting needle compensates for the extra bulk in each stitch.

Concept Mapping for Knitters

KNITTING CONCEPT	CROCHET EQUIVALENT	KEY DIFFERENCE
Cast on	Foundation chain (or chainless foundation)	Chain can curl; chainless foundation gives stretch
Bind off	Fasten off (cut yarn, pull through last loop)	Much simpler, no separate bind-off row
Knit stitch	Single crochet (closest in density)	SC is still thicker than stockinette

KNITTING CONCEPT	CROCHET EQUIVALENT	KEY DIFFERENCE
Purl stitch	Back-loop single crochet or spike stitch	No exact equivalent; texture comes from post stitches
Stockinette	Rows of sc or hdc (similar look from a distance)	True knit-look comes from Tunisian knit stitch or waistcoat stitch
Cables	Front-post / back-post dc cables	Worked without a cable needle; post stitches wrap around the post below
Lace / yarn over	Chain spaces and skipped stitches	Open mesh is created with ch-sp, not yarn overs
DPNs / magic loop	Working in the round with a stitch marker	Only one hook needed; no need to manage needles
Short rows	Turning mid-row (similar principle)	Turning chains replace wraps and turns
Intarsia / Fair Isle	Tapestry crochet or intarsia crochet	Unused yarn is carried inside stitches, not across the back

Common crossover mistakes

Knitters learning crochet most often: (1) work too tightly because they are used to snug knitting tension, (2) forget to count the turning chain as a stitch, and (3) accidentally add or lose stitches at row edges. Count your stitches at the end of every row until it becomes automatic.

SECTION 7

Troubleshooting Crochet

Quick fixes for the most common beginner problems

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Piece is growing wider row by row	Accidentally adding a stitch at the row edge	Count stitches at the end of each row; mark the last stitch with a stitch marker
Piece is shrinking row by row	Missing the last stitch (often the turning chain)	Place a stitch marker in the turning chain; work into it on the return row
Fabric is curling	Foundation chain too tight, or gauge too tight	Use a hook one size larger for the foundation chain; relax your grip
Uneven edges (wavy or jagged)	Inconsistent turning-chain height	Ensure turning chain matches the stitch height; consider chainless turning
Stitches are too tight	Holding yarn too tensely (common for knitters)	Consciously loosen your yarn hand; practice pulling up taller loops
Holes at the base of the turning chain	Gap between the chain and the first stitch	Work a chainless turning stitch, or snug the first stitch close to the chain
Foundation chain twists when joining in the round	Chain twisted before the first join	Lay the chain flat and check alignment before slip stitching to join
Yarn splits while crocheting	Hook tip catching individual plies	Use a hook with a smoother, rounder head; try a different yarn ply
Seams are bulky	Using the same heavy yarn for seaming	Seam with a thinner yarn in the same color, or use whip stitch with fewer plies
Color changes show a dotted line	Changing color in the wrong part of the stitch	Pull the new color through the last two loops of the stitch before the change, not after

Pre-Project Checklist

- ☐ Read the entire pattern once before starting
- ☐ Check whether the pattern uses US or UK terms
- ☐ Verify your hook size against the recommended gauge
- ☐ Make a gauge swatch in the pattern stitch (at least 10 cm square)
- ☐ Count your foundation chain twice before starting Row 1
- ☐ Place a stitch marker in the first stitch of each row
- ☐ Count stitches at the end of every row for the first 10 rows
- ☐ Check your edges after five rows — if they are not straight, frog and restart

Finishing Checklist

- ☐ Weave in all yarn tails at least 5 cm / 2 inches
- ☐ Block the piece to measurements (wet block or steam block)
- ☐ Check seams from the right side before trimming tails
- ☐ Try on wearables (or measure against the schematic) before finishing
- ☐ Photograph your finished project for reference

Next Step

You now have the stitches, the patterns, and the troubleshooting toolkit to start your crochet journey. Pick one beginner project from Section 4, grab a hook and some scrap yarn, and work through it from start to finish. Once that first piece is done, you will have the confidence to tackle the intermediate patterns — and a whole new dimension of your craft to explore.